

would pay me afterwards. I asked them, “Do I have the word ‘STUPID’ written across my forehead?” I had two follow-up meetings with management. I didn’t trust them, so I went to the meetings with a hidden tape recorder.

Eventually they fired me, and I sued them. It took three years for the case to go to trial, and it cost me £350,000 in legal expenses. If I had lost the case, it would have financially wiped me out. We went to court and won the case hands-down.

Did you use your recordings in the trial?

Oh, yes, and they were extremely useful. We furnished Nomura with the tape transcripts, but they still weren’t prepared. At one point in the trial, one of their witnesses testified regarding some conversation.

The judge said, “There is a transcript; show me where he said that.”

He answered, “It’s not there.”

The judge said, “I’ll cross out that section of your statement. What about the next section, would you like me to cross that out as well?”

The tape really helped me in terms of credibility because I had told the absolute truth, while they had lied. I got £1.35 million, which was equal to 15 percent of my profits; it should have been 20 percent. When I look back, even though I won the case, it was a bad decision to sue.

Why is that?

If I had spent the time it took for the litigation to drag out pursuing my own business, I would have made multiples of the £1.35 million settlement. It was a bad trade.

What did you do in those intervening years?

I literally built a house. I dug my own foundation. I did most of the work myself. I hired a builder to help with the things I couldn’t do on my own.

What else occupied you during those three years besides building your own house?

I had my court case, and I was building a house. That occupied all my time.

Did you have any plans about what you were eventually going to do?